Lesson 2: Needs and Wants

Module 1 | 45 minutes | Choices have costs | Grades 3–6 · ages 8–11

Objective: Sort needs from wants, see that the same thing can be either, and explain what you give up when you choose, while planning a ₹500 school trip.

Success criteria

- I can sort things into needs and wants.
- I can explain why the same thing can be a need or a want.
- I can say what I give up when I choose.
- I can buy needs first in a budget.

Key vocabulary

- **need**: Something you must have to be safe, healthy and learn.
- **want**: Something nice to have that you can live without.
- **choice**: Picking one thing instead of another.
- **trade-off**: What you give up when you choose something.
- **emergency money**: Money you keep aside in case something unexpected happens.

You will need

- Projector or screen share with Kitabash (lesson video, activities)
- Devices: 1 per learner (laptop, tablet or phone); a microphone helps for speaking tasks
- Printed worksheet, paper and pencil
- Project files: l02_needs_wants_activity_sheet.md, l02_teacher_script.md

Timed lesson plan (45 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game**	Desert island game: choose five cards out of ten, pairs explain one choice.
4 min	**Watch + thumbs check**	Play the video. Thumbs up/down: “Is chocolate a need?” “Is an umbrella in July a need?”
5 min	**Live demo**	Class T-chart vote with hands up / hands on head; add the “It depends” column. Show the school trip sim going red, then fix it.
6 min	**Build along**	My needs and wants T-chart with ten things from home, stars and “If I buy ___, I give up ___”.
6 min	**Sort race**	Team competition: “Need, want, or it depends?” Teams must defend one “it depends” card.
7 min	**Budget sim**	School trip with ₹500. Poll: which wants did you choose with the last ₹100?

5 min	**Pair talk**	Breakout pairs: “What did it really cost?” and the money words match. Each pair shares one trade-off from their own life.
4 min	**Probe**	New situation: the monsoon umbrella, then “My choice and its cost”.
3 min	**Show-and-tell + exit**	Two learners read their choice and its cost. Exit ticket.

Unplugged warm-up

Desert island game (5 min): show 10 picture cards (water, rice, blanket, medicine, video game, chocolate, toy, comic, torch, ball). Each child may take only five to the island. Pairs compare and explain one choice. Ask: “Which did everyone pick? Which did nobody pick? Why?”

Teaching the idea

A need keeps us safe, healthy and learning; a want is a nice extra. The big idea for this age is that the same item can be either, depending on the situation, and that every choice has a cost: what you give up (opportunity cost, but call it “what you give up”). Use real Indian situations: monsoon umbrellas, school trips, the ice cream cart at the school gate. Wants are not bad; they simply come after needs and are chosen on purpose.

Analogy: Your money is like one plate at a wedding buffet: if you fill it with sweets first, there is no room left for the dal and rice you actually need.

Live demo: 1) Draw a T-chart on screen: NEEDS | WANTS. 2) Call out items and let the class vote with hands up (need) or hands on head (want): water, chocolate, uniform, video game. 3) Say “shoes” and let the class disagree; draw a third column “IT DEPENDS” and explain with school shoes versus a fourth shiny pair. 4) Open the school trip budget sim on screen. Add the soft toy first and show the bar turning red when needs are added. 5) Reset, add the four needs first (₹350), point out ₹150 left, and set aside ₹50. 6) Ask the class to pick wants for the last ₹100.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
What is a need?	Something you must have to be safe, healthy and learn.
Can shoes be a want?	Yes, if you already have the shoes you need; a fourth shiny pair is a want.
Aarav buys a toy car instead of a comic. What did he give up?	The comic.
On the school trip, what do you buy first?	The needs: bus, entry, lunch and water.
Why keep ₹50 safe on the trip?	For an emergency, like a lost water bottle or an extra bus fare.

Differentiation

Support
Use picture cards for sorting and give only two buckets (need or want) first. Add “It depends” after they are confident.

Stretch
Plan the school trip with only ₹400. What do you remove, and what do you give up?

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
Wants are bad.	Wants are fine. We just choose them after the needs, and on purpose.
Something I really, really want is a need.	Ask: what happens if I do not have it? If you are still safe, healthy and learning, it is a want.
If I use pocket money, the choice has no cost.	Every rupee spent on one thing cannot be spent on another. That is the cost.
Everything is always only a need or only a want.	The same thing can be either, depending on the situation.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Name one need, one want, and one thing that could be either. Say why for the last one.

Homework
Finish your T-chart with a grown-up. Ask them about one thing they wanted but chose not to buy, and what they bought instead.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. Need, want, or it depends? (perform · categorize)

Need: Drinking water, Medicine when you are sick, School uniform, Rice and dal
Want: Video game, Chocolate, Toy car, Movie ticket
It depends: Shoes, A new school bag, A mobile phone

2. School trip with ₹500 (perform · budget sim)

Must buy: 🚌 Bus ticket, 🎟️ Zoo entry ticket, 🍱 Lunch, 💧 Water bottle · **Keep at least** ₹50. The four needs cost ₹350. Keeping ₹50 safe leaves ₹100 for wants: for example ice cream and the keychain, or popcorn and the photo. The soft toy alone would break the emergency money.

3. What did it really cost? (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: ₹100 and the comic he could not buy

4. Money words: match each word to its meaning (perform · matching)

Need → Something you must have to live and learn · Want → Something nice to have that you can live without · Choice → Picking one thing instead of another · Trade-off → What you give up when you choose · Budget → A plan for how to use your money

5. New situation: the monsoon umbrella (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: Buy the umbrella first, then save the ₹100 left towards the bat

6. My choice and its cost (probe · free response)

Look for: want, give up. **Example:** I want a new cricket ball for ₹60. It is a want, because I already have an old one. If I buy it, I give up two weeks of ice creams. I think it is worth it, because I play every evening.

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** need = Something you must have to be safe, healthy and learn. · want = Something nice to have that you can live without. · choice = Picking one thing instead of another. · trade-off = What you give up when you choose something.
2. **Need, want, or it depends?:** Need: Drinking water, Medicine when you are sick, School uniform, Rice and dal · Want: Video game, Chocolate, Toy car, Movie ticket · It depends: Shoes, A new school bag, A mobile phone
3. **School trip with ₹500:** Must buy: 🚌 Bus ticket, 🎟️ Zoo entry ticket, 🍱 Lunch, 💧 Water bottle. Keep at least ₹50. The four needs cost ₹350. Keeping ₹50 safe leaves ₹100 for wants: for

example ice cream and the keychain, or popcorn and the photo. The soft toy alone would break the emergency money.

4. **What did it really cost?:** B. ₹100 and the comic he could not buy — Every choice has a cost: the money, and the next best thing you gave up. Aarav gave up the comic.
5. **Money words: match each word to its meaning:** Need → Something you must have to live and learn · Want → Something nice to have that you can live without · Choice → Picking one thing instead of another · Trade-off → What you give up when you choose · Budget → A plan for how to use your money

Kitabash original curriculum.